

Week 1, Wednesday: Hands-On Prompting & Week 1 Assignment

Interacting with AI and Consolidating Week 1 Learnings

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Session Overview

Welcome to Wednesday's session! Today, we shift from theory to practice, focusing on how to effectively communicate with AI and consolidating everything we've learned this week.

- **Segment 1 (1.5 Hours): Live Demonstration & Hands-On Prompting.** We will explore the anatomy of a good prompt, watch a live problem-solving demo, and practice interacting with ChatGPT.
- **Segment 2 (1.5 Hours): Week 1 Assignment Briefing & Q&A.** We will review core concepts (AI/ML/DL, Ethics, Local Use Cases) and break down your first formal continuous assessment.

Session Objectives

By the end of this session, learners will be able to:

- Construct effective prompts using the core components: Role, Context, Instruction, and Format.
- Observe and replicate a live, step-by-step AI problem-solving workflow.
- Independently interact with a Generative AI tool to solve a simple, real-world task.
- Articulate the core concepts covered in Week 1.
- Understand the requirements and expectations for the Week 1 continuous assessment.

Part 1:
Live Demonstration & Hands-On Prompting

"Learning to speak the language of AI."

The Power of Generative AI

What Makes it Powerful?

Generative AI is not just a search engine; it is a **reasoning and synthesis engine**.

- It can draft, summarize, brainstorm, translate, and code.
- However, its output quality is directly proportional to the quality of your input.
- **The Skill:** "Prompt Engineering" is simply the art of clearly communicating your needs to the AI to get the best possible result.

Real-World Problem Scenario

The Scenario

You are a small business owner in Nairobi. A long-standing customer has sent an angry email because their bulk order was delayed by three days due to unexpected supply chain issues.

The Goal: Draft a polite, professional, and empathetic response that apologizes for the delay, explains the situation briefly, and offers a 10% discount on their next order to retain their loyalty.

The Anatomy of a Good Prompt

A highly effective prompt typically contains four key components:

1. **Role:** Who should the AI act as?
2. **Context:** What is the background information?
3. **Instruction:** What exactly do you want the AI to do?
4. **Format & Constraints:** How should the output look (length, tone, style)?

Let's break down each component.

Prompting Principle 1: Role

Assign a Persona

Telling the AI "who" to be helped, it adopt the appropriate vocabulary, tone, and perspective.

- **Weak:** "Write an email."
- **Strong:** "Act as an experienced, empathetic, and professional customer service manager."

Prompting Principle 2: Context

Provide Background Information

AI does not know your specific situation unless you tell it. Provide the necessary facts.

- **Weak:** "The order is late."
- **Strong:** "We have a long-standing relationship with this customer. Their bulk order is delayed by 3 days due to unexpected supply chain issues, but it will ship tomorrow."

Prompting Principle 3: Clear Instructions

Be Specific About the Task

Use strong action verbs and clearly state the desired outcome.

- **Weak:** "Say sorry and give a discount."
- **Strong:** "Draft an email apologizing for the delay, briefly explaining the supply chain issue, and offering a 10% discount code for their next purchase."

Prompting Principle 4: Format & Constraints

Define the Boundaries

Tell the AI how long the output should be and what tone to maintain.

- **Weak:** "Make it nice."
- **Strong:** "Keep the email under 150 words. Maintain a highly professional, empathetic, and solution-oriented tone."

Instructor Live Demo: The "Bad" Prompt

The Vague Prompt

"Write an email to a customer saying their order is late and give them a discount."

Facilitator Action: The instructor will run this prompt live in ChatGPT.

Class Observation: Notice how generic, robotic, or potentially inappropriate the output is. It lacks empathy, specific details, and professional polish.

Instructor Live Demo: The "Good" Prompt

The Structured Prompt

"Act as an empathetic customer service manager. Draft an email to a long-standing customer whose bulk order is delayed by 3 days due to supply chain issues. Apologize sincerely, explain the situation briefly, and offer a 10% discount on their next order. Keep it under 150 words and maintain a professional, solution-oriented tone."

Facilitator Action: The instructor will run this prompt live.

Class Observation: Notice the dramatic improvement in tone, relevance, and usability.

Evaluating the AI Output

Never blindly trust the first output. Always evaluate it against your original constraints:

- **Accuracy:** Did it include the 3-day delay and the 10% discount?
- **Tone:** Is it truly empathetic and professional?
- **Length:** Is it under the 150-word limit?
- **Hallucinations:** Did it invent any facts we didn't provide? (Always fact-check!)

The Art of Iterative Prompting

AI is a **collaborative tool**, not a magic oracle. You rarely get the perfect result on the first try.

Refining the Output (Follow-up Prompt)

"That is a good start, but make the apology sound slightly more personal. Also, add a specific sentence proposing a brief phone call next week to discuss their future needs."

This iterative refinement is the core skill of effective AI interaction.

Hands-On Practice: Your Turn!

Activity Time

Now it is your turn to apply these principles.

- **Action:** Open ChatGPT (or Gemini) on your laptop.
- **Task:** You will draft a response to a different, but equally common, business scenario.
- **Goal:** Use the 4-part prompt structure (Role, Context, Instruction, Format) to get the best possible result.

Hands-On Task: The Scenario

Your Scenario

You are a local tour operator in Kenya. A potential client has emailed asking for a 3-day safari itinerary for a family of four (two adults, two teenagers) with a moderate budget. They are interested in wildlife but also want some cultural experiences.

Your Goal: Generate a structured, engaging, and realistic itinerary draft that you can later refine and send to the client.

Hands-On Task: Your Prompt Template

Fill in the blanks and run your prompt in ChatGPT:

```
Act as a [ROLE].
Context: [PROVIDE DETAILS ABOUT THE CLIENT AND BUDGET].
Instruction: Draft a 3-day safari itinerary that includes [SPECIFIC REQUESTS].
Format: Present it as a day-by-day bulleted list. Keep the tone enthusiastic and professional.
    Limit to 250 words.

```

Instructor will walk around to assist and review your prompts!

Troubleshooting Your Prompts

If your output isn't quite right, try these fixes:

- **Too generic?** Add more specific context (e.g., "Include Maasai Mara and a visit to a local village").
- **Too long?** Explicitly state: "Summarize this into 3 concise bullet points."
- **Wrong tone?** Add: "Rewrite this to sound more formal/friendly/urgent."
- **Hallucinating?** Add: "Only use factual, well-known safari locations in Kenya."

Common Prompting Pitfalls

What to Avoid

- **Vagueness:** "Write something about safaris." (The AI has to guess your intent).
- **Overloading:** Asking the AI to write an itinerary, code a website, and translate a document in one prompt. Break complex tasks into steps.
- **Assuming Context:** Forgetting that the AI does not remember your previous, unrelated chats unless they are in the same thread.

Part 2:
Week 1 Assignment Briefing & Q&A

"Consolidating our foundational knowledge."

Segment 2: Week 1 Assignment Briefing & Q&A

Before we dive into the assignment details, let's do a rapid-fire review of the core concepts we have covered this week to ensure everyone is on the same page.

Week 1 Recap: The AI Family Tree

- **Artificial Intelligence (AI):** The broad vision of machines acting intelligently.
- **Machine Learning (ML):** A subset of AI where systems learn patterns from data rather than following explicit, hard-coded rules.
- **Deep Learning (DL):** A specialized subset of ML using multi-layered artificial neural networks to solve highly complex problems (e.g., image recognition, LLMs).

Week 1 Recap: Data, Bias & Ethics

- **GIGO:** Garbage In, Garbage Out. Flawed data leads to flawed AI.
- **Bias:** Algorithms can inherit and amplify human prejudices from historical training data.
- **Ethical Pillars:** Responsible AI must prioritize **Privacy** (consent/security), **Transparency** (explainability), and **Fairness** (non-discrimination).

Week 1 Recap: AI in the Kenyan Context

AI is actively transforming local industries:

- **FinTech:** Alternative credit scoring (e.g., M-Pesa based lending) and fraud detection.
- **AgriTech:** Crop disease detection via smartphone cameras (e.g., PlantVillage Nuru) and hyper-local weather prediction.
- **Customer Service:** Localized chatbots understanding Swahili and Sheng.

Week 1 Assignment Overview

Continuous Assessment 1: AI in Your Daily Life

Objective: To build conscious awareness of the "invisible" AI that already powers our daily digital lives and business operations.

This is a low-stakes, foundational assignment designed to get you observing the world through an "AI lens."

Assignment Task: AI in Your Daily Life

The Task:
Identify **three (3)** Artificial Intelligence tools, features, or algorithms that you interact with on a weekly basis, and explain how they are used.

Crucial Guidance

Look **beyond** the obvious conversational AI (like ChatGPT or Gemini). Think about the algorithms working quietly behind the scenes in apps and devices you use every day.

Assignment Guidelines: Looking Beyond the Obvious

Need inspiration? Consider these categories:

- **Social Media:** The TikTok "For You" page or Instagram Explore feed (Recommendation Engines).
- **Streaming Services:** Netflix movie suggestions or Spotify's "Discover Weekly" playlist.
- **Smartphone Features:** FaceID, predictive text keyboards, or computational photography (e.g., Night Mode).
- **Communication:** Gmail or Outlook spam and phishing filters.
- **Navigation:** Google Maps or Ma3route predicting traffic patterns and estimating arrival times.

Examples of "Invisible" AI

Example 1: Gmail Spam Filter

- **Task:** Automatically detects and separates junk/phishing emails from the primary inbox.
- **Data Hypothesis:** It likely analyzes keywords in the subject line, the sender's domain reputation, and my past behavior of marking similar emails as spam.

Your assignment should follow this level of detail for all three tools.

Assignment Submission Requirements

For **each** of the 3 tools you select, your submission must clearly include:

1. **Name of the tool/feature:** (e.g., "Google Maps Route Optimization").
2. **The specific task it performs:** (e.g., "Predicts the fastest route by analyzing real-time traffic data and historical patterns").
3. **A brief hypothesis on the data it uses:** (e.g., "It uses anonymized GPS location data from other users' phones, road closure reports, and time-of-day historical traffic averages").

Assignment Formatting & Due Date

- **Format:** A simple 1-page Word document OR a 3-slide PowerPoint presentation. Clarity is more important than elaborate design.
- **Naming Convention:** `FirstName_LastName_Week1_AI_Assignment.pdf`
- **Submission Platform:** Upload to the Mediacrest Student Portal / LMS.
- **Due Date:** Before the start of next week's session (Sunday, 11:59 PM).

Tips for a High-Scoring Assignment

How to Excel

- **Be Specific:** Do not just say "Netflix uses AI." Say "Netflix's Recommendation Algorithm uses collaborative filtering."
- **Think About Data:** The "Data Hypothesis" section is where you demonstrate your understanding of the "Data is Destiny" principle from Tuesday's class.
- **Proofread:** Ensure your explanations are clear, concise, and free of grammatical errors.

Open Q&A Session

The Floor is Yours

This is the time to clear up any doubts before the end of Week 1.

You can ask about:

- Any confusion regarding the Week 1 Assignment requirements.
- Concepts from earlier in the week (AI vs. ML, Bias, Ethics).
- Technical issues with setting up ChatGPT, Gemini, or Teachable Machine.
- How AI might apply to your specific career goals or business ideas.

Q&A Discussion Prompts

If you are unsure what to ask, consider these thought-provoking questions:

- *"If AI makes a mistake in a business setting, who is held responsible: the user, the developer, or the company?"*
- *"How can we, as future AI practitioners in Kenya, ensure our local datasets are representative and unbiased?"*
- *"What is the biggest limitation of the free tier of ChatGPT that we should be aware of?"*

Wrap-up & Next Steps

- **Today's Takeaway:** You now have first-hand experience interacting with a Generative AI tool using structured prompting, and you have clear instructions for your Week 1 continuous assessment.
- **Next Session (Thursday/Friday):**
  - We will begin our **Data Basics** track.
  - Learn how to find, clean, and prepare datasets using Google Sheets/Excel.
  - Understand features, labels, and data preprocessing before feeding data to an ML model.

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